1. Ethereum and Decentralized Finance (DeFi) – 2020 onwards

Description: Ethereum is the most widely used platform for decentralized applications (dApps) and smart contracts. DeFi applications, built on Ethereum, allow users to borrow, lend, trade, and earn interest on cryptocurrencies without the need for traditional financial intermediaries.

Notable Projects: Uniswap (decentralized exchange), Aave (lending protocol), and Compound (interest rate markets).

Year: The DeFi boom began in 2020 and continues to grow.

Suggestion for Comments and Opinions:

What makes DeFi projects like Uniswap or Aave a disruptive innovation in traditional finance?

How secure do you think these decentralized platforms are, considering recent hacks?

Could traditional banks adopt blockchain technologies to compete with DeFi, or will these platforms replace them?